

# Link edge cases

Links are syntactically simple (`[text](url)`) but the edges are where parsers diverge: brackets in link text, parens in URLs, titles, autolinks, mixing with formatting.

## Title syntax

A link with a title: [click](#).

Titles can use single quotes: [click](#).

Or parens: [click](#).

## Brackets in link text

A link with [literal brackets] in the text: [link with \[brackets\] here](#).

A link containing **bold** and *italic*: [bold and italic](#).

A link containing inline code: [click for code](#).

## Parens in URL

Standard parens-in-URL: [Wikipedia article](#).

A URL with multiple parens: [search](#).

Note: when the URL contains literal parens, the closing one needs to be escaped or the parser will end the URL early. We support both `\(` and `\)`.

## Autolink forms

Angle-bracket autolink: <https://example.com> — URL as both text and target.

Bare autolink (GFM extension): <https://example.com> — also rendered as a link.

Email autolink (GFM extension): [contact@example.com](mailto:contact@example.com) — rendered with `mailto:`.

## Many links in one paragraph

Five [link](#) [tokens](#) [in](#) [one](#) [sentence](#).

## Link without protocol

A bare hostname autolink (GFM extension): [www.example.com](http://www.example.com) renders with an implicit `http://`.

A path-only host: [example.com/page](http://example.com/page) — should also be detected.

## Link at end of sentence

A link with [punctuation](#). The trailing period should NOT be part of the URL.

Comma cases: [a](#), [b](#), [c](#).

Question mark and exclamation: see [this](#)? Or [that](#)!

## Link in a heading

Heading with [a link](#)

Body text follows.

## Link in a list

- [item one with link](#)
- [item two](#)
- plain item three
- [item four](#) with trailing text

## Link in a quote

| A quote with [a link inside](#).

| A second paragraph with [another link](#).

## Link in a table

| Page | URL                              |
|------|----------------------------------|
| Home | <a href="#">example.com</a>      |
| Docs | <a href="#">example.com/docs</a> |

## Same URL many times

[click](#) [click](#) [click](#) [click](#) [click](#)

The PDF should contain five distinct link annotations, each clickable, pointing at the same URL. Deduplication would be a bug (it would make some clicks dead).